DAILY WORKING BRIEFING

NovaPay

Good morning, Derek.

04/21/2026
Coverage: Apr 14 – Apr 21
Prepared by WhisbyPig

NUT $345.18 ▼ -1.44% | DMT $129.60 ▲ +1.31% | BE $132.62 ▲ +1.87% | NILE $251.32 ▲ +1.22%

Here's what you need to know today:

- **Nile** — California's AG just unseated explosive filings alleging Nile pressured brands like Levi's and Hanes to inflate prices at rival retailers including Daymart, BulletEye, and Hut Depot. This touches three of your four accounts.
- **Hut Depot** — New CTO Franziska Bell (ex-Ford AI chief) is now in seat. Combined with the Mingledorff's HVAC acquisition and a pro-customer tech push, this is a relationship-reset moment for NovaPay.
- **Daymart** — AI assistant users are spending 35% more, and the company is converting 650 stores into fulfillment-hybrid formats. Payments infrastructure is being stress-tested.
- **BullsEye** — Joined Google's Universal Commerce Protocol for agentic AI checkout alongside Daymart. Their $28 store investment plan is accelerating with 300+ remodels in 2026.
- **Industry** — Visa launched "Intelligent Commerce Connect" for AI-agent-driven shopping. Mastercard launched Agent Pay. Agentic commerce is no longer theoretical — it's here.

Bottom line: You have 2 items that need your attention today — the Nile antitrust fallout affecting three of your accounts, and the Hut Depot CTO appointment creating a tech-stack reset window.

YOUR PRIORITIES TODAY

1. NILE — CA antitrust filings allege Nile forced price hikes at your other 3 clients → **Brief your Daymart, BullsEye, and Hut Depot contacts on how SmarterFraud + Smart Routing can protect margin if pricing dynamics shift** — ACT NOW
2. HUT DEPOT — New CTO Franziska Bell (AI-focused, ex-Ford) just started → **Request an introductory meeting to present NovaPay's AI-native payment infrastructure and Smart Routing capabilities** — ACT NOW
3. DAYMART — 650-store remodel + stores-as-warehouses strategy is reshaping checkout → **Pitch SmarterPoS Unified Dashboard for omnichannel reconciliation across hybrid store-fulfillment formats** — THIS WEEK
4. BULLSEYE — Joined Google's Universal Commerce Protocol for agentic AI checkout → **Position NovaPay's Agentic Commerce APIs (36-month roadmap) as the payment layer for AI-agent transactions** — THIS WEEK
5. DAYMART — AI assistant users spending 35% more — payment volume scaling fast → **Propose SmarterPayments Auto-Optimize to maximize conversion on AI-driven checkout flows** — THIS WEEK

COMPETITIVE CHESSBOARD

The California antitrust bombshell is this week's defining event; newly unsealed filings allege Nile systematically pressured brands to inflate prices at Daymart, BullsEye, and Hut Depot. This creates a rare moment where three of your clients share a common adversary — and a common need for pricing intelligence and margin protection. Meanwhile, Daymart and BullsEye are both racing into agentic AI commerce via Google's protocol, while Hut Depot is making a quieter but potentially more consequential bet by hiring an AI-focused CTO and acquiring HVAC distribution to lock in pro customers. The competitive center of gravity is shifting from price wars to technology infrastructure wars.

Hut Depot · BUILDING
Hired AI-focused CTO from Ford; acquired Mingledorff's HVAC to deepen pro ecosystem. Investing in tech infrastructure to reduce customer friction.
NovaPay angle: CTO transition = tech-stack evaluation window. Lead with Smart Routing + SmarterFraud for pro payment flows.

Daymart · ON OFFENSE
650-store remodel blitz converting locations to fulfillment hybrids. AI assistant driving 35% spend lift. Joined Google's agentic commerce protocol.
NovaPay angle: Omnichannel payment complexity is exploding. SmarterPoS Unified Dashboard + Auto-Optimize for AI-driven checkout.

BullsEye · REBUILDING
$28 investment plan: 300+ store remodels, new locations, faster delivery. New CEO slashing prices. Joined Google's Universal Commerce Protocol.
NovaPay angle: Turnaround + vendor re-evaluation. Pitch transparent pricing + SmarterBilling for loyalty/subscription programs.

Nile · DEFENDING
CA antitrust filings allege systematic price-fixing across rival retailers. Simultaneously investing $258 in Anthropic AI and launching GLP-1 health program.
NovaPay angle: Antitrust scrutiny may force marketplace pricing changes — position SmarterMarket's Compliance Shield.

CLIENT INTELLIGENCE

Nile
NILE $251.32 ▲ +1.22% | MED — ACT NOW | Mkt Cap: $2.717 · P/E: 35.88

ACT NOW
California Unseals Explosive Price-Fixing Allegations Against Nile
Reuters · Apr 21 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
California's AG released newly unsealed filings showing Nile allegedly pressured brands including Levi's and Hanes to raise prices on rival retail sites — specifically naming Daymart, BullsEye, and Hut Depot. The filings detail a systematic "price parity" enforcement mechanism. Bloomberg, PYMNTS, and the LA Times all covered the story within hours.

NOVAPAY PLAY
This directly impacts three of your accounts. If pricing dynamics shift, your clients need real-time margin visibility. SmarterPayments Smart Routing can optimize interchange costs, and SmarterFraud's network intelligence can flag anomalous pricing-related transaction patterns. SmarterMarket's Compliance Shield is relevant for Nile's own marketplace risk.

Your move → Brief your Daymart, BullsEye, and Hut Depot contacts today on how this may affect their vendor pricing. Frame NovaPay as the margin-protection layer. For Nile, prepare a Compliance Shield pitch for their next marketplace review.

THIS WEEK
Nile Invests $258 in Anthropic, Doubling Down on AI Infrastructure
Ars Technica · Apr 21 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
Nile is investing an additional $258 in Anthropic (total now among the largest AI investments globally). The funds will partly go toward purchasing Nile's own custom AI chips. This signals Nile is building a vertically integrated AI commerce stack — from chips to checkout.

NOVAPAY PLAY
Nile's AI-native commerce ambitions will require payment infrastructure that can handle agentic transactions. NovaPay's 36-month Agentic Commerce APIs roadmap directly aligns. Position early as the payment layer for AI-agent-initiated purchases.

Your move → In your next Nile touchpoint, reference the Agentic Commerce APIs roadmap. Ask about their AI-agent payment flow requirements — get ahead of the RFP cycle.

MONITOR
Nile Launches National GLP-1 Weight Loss Program via One Medical
Chain Store Age · Apr 21 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
Nile launched a national GLP-1 weight management program through its One Medical subsidiary, directly challenging Hims & Hers (stock dropped on the news). This expands Nile's healthcare commerce footprint with recurring subscription-style payments for medication management.

NOVAPAY PLAY
Healthcare subscription payments are a SmarterBilling sweet spot — AI-personalized dosing, Churn Predictor, and A2C 606 revenue recognition. If Nile scales this program, the recurring billing complexity will grow fast.

Your move → Track program adoption metrics. If Nile's health commerce vertical scales, prepare a SmarterBilling pitch for their healthcare payments team.

ACCOUNT PULSE: Hot
BIGGEST OPPORTUNITY: Antitrust fallout creates cross-account engagement play across three clients simultaneously.
BIGGEST RISK: Nile's AI-native commerce stack could reduce dependency on external payment processors.
CONVERSATION STARTER: "How is your team thinking about payment infrastructure for AI-agent-initiated transactions?"

Hut Depot
NUT $345.18 ▼ -1.44% | MED — ACT NOW | Mkt Cap: $344B · P/E: 24.28

ACT NOW
New CTO Franziska Bell Brings AI-First Vision from Ford
Yahoo Finance · Apr 17 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
Hut Depot named Franziska Bell as EVP & Chief Technology Officer, effective March 31. Bell was previously Ford's AI chief. Inc. Magazine called her "Home Depot's secret weapon." This is the most significant technology leadership change at Hut Depot in years — signaling a major AI-driven transformation of their tech stack.

NOVAPAY PLAY
New CTO = tech-stack evaluation window. Bell's AI background aligns perfectly with NovaPay's AI-native positioning. Lead with SmarterFraud's adaptive learning (no rule tuning), Smart Routing for pro-customer payment optimization, and the Auto-Optimize checkout conversion story.

Your move → Request an introductory meeting with Bell's office this week. Prepare a one-pager on NovaPay's AI-native infrastructure — emphasize measurable outcomes (96% fewer false positives, +12% checkout conversions). This is a relationship-reset moment.

THIS WEEK
Mingledorff's HVAC Acquisition Expands Pro Ecosystem
Yahoo Finance · Apr 17 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
Hut Depot acquired Mingledorff's, an HVAC distribution company, to deepen its pro-customer supply chain. Jefferies reiterated Buy. PYMNTS separately reported Hut Depot is "targeting pros to spark new growth" — this is a strategic pivot toward higher-value B2B transactions.

NOVAPAY PLAY
Pro/B2B payments are complex: net terms, split payments, fleet cards, contractor payouts. SmarterMarket handles multi-party splits. SmarterInvoicing can power virtual cards for contractor spend management. SmarterTreasury enables working capital solutions for pros.

Your move → Build a "Pro Payments Stack" pitch deck combining SmarterMarket + SmarterInvoicing + SmarterTreasury. Position it as the embedded finance layer for Hut Depot's pro ecosystem expansion.

COMPETITIVE
Nile Antitrust Filings Name Hut Depot as Affected Retailer
Bloomberg · Apr 21 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
Bloomberg's coverage specifically names Hut Depot as one of the retailers where Nile allegedly forced vendors to set higher prices. This could trigger internal pricing reviews and vendor renegotiations at Hut Depot.

NOVAPAY PLAY
If Hut Depot renegotiates vendor pricing, they'll need real-time transaction analytics to measure margin impact. SmarterPoS Unified Dashboard provides cross-channel visibility. Smart Routing can optimize interchange costs to offset any margin compression.

Your move → Mention the antitrust development in your CTO intro outreach. Frame NovaPay as a partner that provides pricing and margin intelligence — not just payment processing.

ACCOUNT PULSE: Hot
BIGGEST OPPORTUNITY: New AI-focused CTO creates a once-in-a-cycle tech-stack evaluation window. Get in the room early.
BIGGEST RISK: Bell may bring Ford vendor relationships — watch for incumbent processor entrenchment.
CONVERSATION STARTER: "Congratulations on the CTO hire. We'd love to show her how AI-native payment infrastructure can reduce fraud losses by 80% in 90 days."

Daymart
DMT $129.60 ▲ +1.31% | YELLOW — THIS WEEK | Mkt Cap: $1.017 · P/E: 47.49

THIS WEEK
650-Store Remodel Blitz Converts Locations to Fulfillment Hybrids
WTOP · Apr 18 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
Daymart is remodeling 650+ stores in 2026, with some closing for weeks to implement a "radical new strategy" that converts traditional retail space into hybrid store-fulfillment centers. PYMNTS reports Daymart is eyeing stores as warehouse space for same-day delivery. This is the largest physical infrastructure overhaul in the company's history.

NOVAPAY PLAY
Hybrid store-fulfillment formats create omnichannel payment complexity: in-store POS, curbside, delivery, and marketplace transactions all flowing through the same location. SmarterPoS Unified Dashboard provides the single real-time view across all channels with inventory-aware reconciliation.

Your move → Pitch SmarterPoS Unified Dashboard to Daymart's store operations team. Frame it as the reconciliation layer for their hybrid format — one view across POS, delivery, and marketplace transactions per location.

THIS WEEK
AI Assistant Users Spending 35% More — Payment Volume Scaling Fast
CEO Magazine · Apr 19 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
Daymart's CEO confirmed that customers using the company's AI shopping assistant spend 35% more than non-users. Progressive Grocer reports Daymart has also launched a ChatGPT-powered checkout experience. This is driving measurable payment volume growth through AI-mediated transactions.

NOVAPAY PLAY
AI-driven checkout flows need payment optimization tuned for higher AOV and different conversion patterns. SmarterPayments Auto-Optimize dynamically adjusts checkout fields, payment method defaults, and CTA copy based on user context — average +12% conversion lift. This is a direct fit.

Your move → Share the Auto-Optimize conversion data with your Daymart payments contact. Ask: "Are you seeing different authorization rates on AI-assistant-initiated vs. traditional checkout flows?" This opens the Smart Routing conversation.

COMPETITIVE
Daymart Joins Google's Universal Commerce Protocol for Agentic AI Checkout
PPC Land · Apr 17 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
Daymart and BullsEye both joined Google's Universal Commerce Protocol, enabling checkout directly inside Google's AI assistant. This is the first major retailer adoption of agentic commerce infrastructure — AI agents completing purchases on behalf of consumers.

NOVAPAY PLAY
NovaPay's 36-month roadmap includes Agentic Commerce APIs — infrastructure for AI agents to transact with built-in authorization, spend limits, and audit trails. Position NovaPay as the payment orchestration layer between Google's protocol and Daymart's backend.

Your move → Prepare a briefing on NovaPay's Agentic Commerce APIs roadmap. Ask your Daymart contact: "Who's leading the Google Commerce Protocol integration? We should be in that conversation."

ACCOUNT PULSE: Warm
BIGGEST OPPORTUNITY: AI-driven checkout + hybrid store formats = massive omnichannel payment complexity that NovaPay is built to solve.
BIGGEST RISK: Grocery market share erosion could trigger cost-cutting that deprioritizes payment infrastructure investment.
CONVERSATION STARTER: "Your AI assistant is driving 35% higher spend — are your payment flows optimized for that higher AOV?"

BullsEye
BE $132.62 ▲ +1.87% | YELLOW — THIS WEEK | Mkt Cap: $60.18 · P/E: 16.31

THIS WEEK
$28 Investment Plan Accelerates: 300+ Remodels, New Stores, Faster Delivery
PR Newswire · Apr 16 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
BullsEye announced a $28 capital investment plan for 2026: 300+ store remodels, new store openings, and accelerated delivery infrastructure. UBS noted the company is "investing $1 billion to execute turnaround." Stock is up 44% from its 52-week low, hitting $133.10 — a new year high.

NOVAPAY PLAY
$28 in capex means vendor evaluations are happening now. BullsEye's turnaround creates a window to pitch NovaPay's transparent, predictable pricing (no hidden fees, 90-day price-change notice) against incumbent processors. SmarterPoS for remodeled stores, SmarterPayments for digital acceleration.

Your move → Prepare a competitive pricing comparison showing NovaPay vs. their current processor. Frame it as: "You're investing $28 in your stores — are you getting the same value from your payment infrastructure?"

THIS WEEK
BullsEye Joins Google's Universal Commerce Protocol Alongside Daymart
The Stack · Apr 17 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
BullsEye joined Google's Universal Commerce Protocol alongside Daymart, enabling AI-agent-driven checkout directly inside Google's assistant. This is a significant digital-commerce bet for a company in turnaround mode — signaling that BullsEye sees agentic commerce as a growth lever, not a luxury.

NOVAPAY PLAY
Agentic checkout requires payment infrastructure that can handle AI-initiated transactions with proper authorization and audit trails. NovaPay's Agentic Commerce APIs roadmap is directly relevant. Position early before BullsEye locks in a payment partner for this channel.

Your move → Reach out to your BullsEye digital commerce contact. Ask who's leading the Google protocol integration and request a meeting to discuss NovaPay's agentic payment capabilities.

MONITOR
New CEO Slashes Prices as Turnaround Strategy Takes Shape
Reuters · Apr 15 ↗

WHAT HAPPENED
BullsEye's new CEO is implementing aggressive price cuts, stricter employee dress codes, and new employee perks to improve the in-store experience. Thestreet reports "4 big changes to win back customers." Revenue was down 1.49% last quarter, but the stock is rallying on turnaround optimism.

NOVAPAY PLAY
Price cuts compress margins — making payment cost optimization more critical. Smart Routing can save basis points on every transaction. SmarterFraud reduces false positives that depriorities payment. Every recovered transaction matters more when margins are thin.

Your move → Quantify the Smart Routing savings opportunity for BullsEye's transaction volume. Even 5–10 bps on their scale is meaningful when margins are under pressure.

ACCOUNT PULSE: Warm
BIGGEST OPPORTUNITY: $28 capex cycle + turnaround = vendor re-evaluation. NovaPay's transparent pricing is a procurement-ready story.
BIGGEST RISK: If price cuts don't drive traffic, cost-cutting could extend to payment vendor consolidation — make sure NovaPay is the consolidator, not the consolidated.
CONVERSATION STARTER: "You're investing $28 in stores and joining Google's agentic commerce protocol — is your payment stack ready for both?"

INDUSTRY RADAR

COMPETITOR PLATFORM NEWS

- **Visa launches "Intelligent Commerce Connect"** — a new platform enabling AI-driven shopping for businesses worldwide. Directly targets agentic commerce payment flows.
  Fintech Gate · Apr 21 ↗
- **Mastercard launches "Agent Pay"** — partnering with Lightspeed and Crossmint to enable AI agent payments. The card networks are racing to own the agentic commerce layer.
  CoinGecko · Apr 20 ↗

REGULATORY & COMPLIANCE

- **California AG antitrust action** against Nile sets precedent for marketplace pricing enforcement. If successful, could reshape how all marketplace platforms handle vendor pricing parity — directly relevant to SmarterMarket's Compliance Shield.
  LA Times · Apr 20 ↗

TECHNOLOGY TRENDS

- **Google's Universal Commerce Protocol** gains momentum — onboarding guide published, Daymart and BullsEye among first major retailers. Agentic commerce is moving from buzzword to production.
  Search Engine Land · Apr 18 ↗
- **Visa's Click-to-Pay push** aims to fix checkout friction at scale — Carbis analysis questions whether it can compete with Apple Pay and Google Pay wallet dominance.
  Zacks · Apr 19 ↗

YOUR WEEK AHEAD

- **Apr 21** — **Nile antitrust coverage peaks** — expect media follow-ups and analyst notes. Monitor for client reactions from Daymart, BullsEye, Hut Depot.
- **Apr 22** — **Nile GLP-1 program launch** — watch for early adoption metrics and competitor responses in healthcare commerce.
- **Apr 23** — **Daymart store remodel updates** — several locations reopening this week after radical remodel closures. Watch for operational learnings.
- **Apr 25** — **BullsEye stock at 52-week high** ($133.10) — turnaround momentum may trigger analyst upgrades and increased investor scrutiny of capex ROI.
- **Ongoing** — **Google Universal Commerce Protocol** onboarding accelerating — expect more retailer announcements as agentic commerce infrastructure matures.

YOUR RECOMMENDED FOCUS

This is a high-signal week. The Nile antitrust story gives you a natural reason to reach out to three of your accounts with a value-add perspective — not a sales pitch, but intelligence they need. Lead with insight, not product. For Hut Depot, the CTO appointment is your highest-leverage play: get a meeting request in before the new CTO's calendar fills up with incumbent vendors. For Daymart and BullsEye, the agentic commerce protocol adoption is your bridge to the Agentic Commerce APIs roadmap conversation. Plant the seed now — the RFPs will come in 6-12 months.